

In other words, knowledge that comes to mind faster has an impact on the future decisions we make. And, just like the hindsight bias, this bias is linked to a memory inaccuracy.

It is, however, an overemphasis on a specific recollection, rather than a creation of a memory.

If someone is being considered for a promotion at work, but their employer remembers one terrible thing that happened years ago but made a lasting impression, that one event could have a disproportionate impact on the final decision.

Another common example is someone purchasing lottery tickets because the lifestyle and benefits associated with winning (as well as the potential emotions associated with winning or seeing others win) are more readily available in the mind than the complex probability calculation of actually winning the lottery.

Finally, witnessing multiple television episodes or news broadcasts on shark attacks (or anything else sensationalised by the news, such as serial killers or plane disasters) may lead you to believe that this incidence is relatively regular, even if it is not.

Confirmation Bias

The tendency to view new information as confirmation of preexisting thoughts and attitudes is known as confirmation bias.

When psychologists selectively interpret data or overlook unfavourable facts in order to obtain conclusions that support their initial theory, this type of bias is common.

Confirmation bias is also very common on the internet, especially on social media. We are prone to reading online news stories that support our beliefs while ignoring those that contradict them.

Various social media platforms, such as Facebook, feed us articles that we are likely to agree



Probably the most common bias